

Plaque with equestrian ọba (king) and attendants

Edo peoples, Benin, c.1540–70 · Brass, 49.5 × 41.9 cm · Photograph; the original is in The Metropolitan Museum of Art, New York (1978.412.309)

The king sits on horseback at the centre, held up by attendants, with smaller figures around him. Plaques like this were fixed to the palace pillars as the court's own record.

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